

## Step Four

### Learning to spend mindfully

'Consumer culture promises us that we can buy our way out of pain – that the reason we're sad and angry is not that being human hurts; it's because we don't have those countertops, her thighs, these jeans. This is a clever way to run an economy, but it's no way to run a life'

Glennon Doyle, *Untamed*<sup>1</sup>

It's very hard to live with a budget or execute better money habits successfully if your spending is completely out of control, because no matter how well something works on paper, the numbers won't translate into your experience of life unless your real-life actions match your theoretical ones. That's not to say that there can be no room for spontaneity, only that life is easier when you are spending with intention and attention most of the time.

This is another place where external factors shoulder a lot (though not all) of the blame for our habits. In order to have a healthy relationship with spending, we have to learn to push back against a lot of outside pressure, and that can be really